

# Evgenii Zaitsev

## Product Manager · CRM and internal products

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Saint Petersburg · Russian / English · Technical background

## PMP (PMI, 2023) · Certified ScrumMaster (2023) · HSE: Master in Management, professional education with distinction

At Samolet, I lead two CRM products from user research to release. My team and I reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. At EmTalk, my team and I released two Android apps.

## Experience & responsibility

### Samolet | Apr 2026 - present

Product Manager · Internal CRM products

With the team, reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to 2 weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. Responsible for two internal CRM products.

- Used customer discovery and stakeholder conversations to identify blockers in sales workflows and prioritise fixes.
- Designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements: user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development.

### EmTalk | Feb 2023 - present

Founder / Product Owner

Conducted 50+ customer discovery interviews during research and built a team without an initial budget. Together, released BRET and Decision Matrix on Google Play.

- Defined product strategy, requirements, backlog and priorities.
- Conducted user, market and competitor research; prepared business model and GTM materials.

### Freelance / Project engagements | Jun 2023 - Nov 2024

Project / Product Manager

At Kickidler: roadmap, RACI and MoSCoW. In other client-side engagements: migration to microservices with Kafka and SAP/1C reporting automation.

- Kickidler: RACI, MoSCoW, roadmap, feature and architectural improvement work.
- Prepared a digital product concept and MVP requirements; implementation stopped when funding ended.

### Statistics & Control / Statcontrol | Jul 2019 - Feb 2023

Technical Product Owner / Project Manager

OptiRamp: discovery, digital twins, forecasting and implementation. Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS and migration automation.

- Worked with Russian and international clients from presales and problem discovery through OptiRamp implementation and testing.
- Introduced Kanban and task evaluation, improved feedback and engineer onboarding.

### Gazprom avtomatizatsia | Oct 2017 - Jul 2019

Team Leader

Control systems for gas turbines and gas transport facilities. Engineering and on-site team leadership, including assignments beyond the Arctic Circle.

- Developed control software; contributed to commissioning, FAT and SAT.
- Coordinated the team and delivery, prepared project documentation.

## Product stories

### **Samolet: from user friction to faster delivery**

Two CRM products, a newly assembled team and low adoption. I started with discovery and priority fixes, then changed requirements, early QA involvement and analytics.

#### **Context and priorities**

I joined a newly assembled team in April 2026. Sales users often chose other tools. Through customer discovery and conversations with sales managers and regional leads, I identified workflow blockers and prioritised fixes.

#### **Discovery and delivery decisions**

I designed an ICONIX-based approach to requirements using user flows, use cases and PlantUML sequence diagrams, reviewed before development. We involved QA earlier and introduced human-reviewed AI-generated test cases, automation and SDD.

#### **An internal analytics product**

Before a product analyst joined, I built an agent-assisted tool for working with ClickHouse, using AI during development. It provided initial reports for product decisions. An analyst later adopted the approach, and the tool remains in use internally.

#### **Team results**

We reduced time-to-market from 1.5 months to two weeks and defect leakage from ~30% to 11%. My contribution covered priorities, requirements, early QA involvement and stakeholder collaboration. These were shared results of process changes, not the effect of a single tool.

#### **Work still in progress**

Adoption remains a challenge: product metrics have started to improve but are still weak. We continue root-cause analysis and work on workflows and usage habits. Faster delivery alone does not establish product success.

### **EmTalk: from research to two apps**

I build a project focused on mental well-being and decision-making. Together with the team, we moved from customer discovery to BRET, Decision Matrix and a content website.

#### **Starting point**

During research, conducted more than 50 customer discovery interviews and studied the market and competitors. Built a part-time team without an initial budget to explore useful well-being and decision-making scenarios.

#### **My role and actions**

Founder and product lead: strategy, market and competitor research, requirements, backlog, prioritisation and team coordination. I prepared the pitch deck, investor materials and a go-to-market plan.

#### **From research to release**

Together with the team, brought BRET and Decision Matrix to publication on Google Play. The EmTalk website offers five tests and nine articles, including an article with an audio version.

#### **The products**

BRET brings together well-being practices. Decision Matrix helps compare options: its official listing describes categories, Pros & Cons, decision history and AI suggestions for alternatives.

#### **What this experience demonstrates**

Founder experience across the product cycle: research, strategy, team coordination and release. My contribution is product and organisational work; the apps and website are a team outcome.

<https://www.emtalk.org/>

BRET · Google Play

Decision Matrix · Google Play

## Systems, teams & approach

### Kickidler: Priorities and team collaboration

#### Context

Software for employee activity monitoring. Worked as Product Manager from July to November 2024.

#### My role and actions

Introduced RACI and MoSCoW for ownership and prioritisation. Introduced a roadmap and worked with the team on the testing module and architectural improvements.

#### What this experience demonstrates

Product prioritisation and attention to how teams make decisions and deliver changes.

### Statistics & Control: Turning complex systems into manageable work

#### Context

Worked in a four-person team on Honeywell DCS reverse engineering and scripts for equipment-version migrations. Later moved to OptiRamp, digital twins, forecasting and modelling for Russian and international clients.

#### My role and actions

Coordinated the team and delivery; worked on requirements, risks and presales. Introduced Kanban, task evaluation, feedback and engineer onboarding processes. Prepared proposals for organisational transformation.

#### Connection to today's work

This experience helps me understand complex workflows, collaborate with engineering teams and connect requirements to business needs.

## Skills & tools

Product discovery, customer development, stakeholder management, roadmap, prioritisation, Scrum, Kanban. ClickHouse, ICONIX, PlantUML, AI-assisted analytics, SDD. Jira, Figma, PostgreSQL. Python: basic. Russian: native. English: self-assessed B2+/C1.

## Education & learning

Peter the Great St Petersburg Polytechnic University - Technical education, master's studies · 2009-2015

HSE · Master in Management - Professional education programme, with distinction · 2021-2022

PMP / Certified ScrumMaster - PMI / Scrum Alliance · 2023

Machine Learning / Deep Learning - SkillFactory · 2022